

Table 12.5 : Whipple's Index by District and Sex, 2012 and 2024

District	2012			2024			Percentage Change
	Both sexes	Male	Female	Both sexes	Male	Female	
Sri Lanka	100.2	100.3	100.0	99.2	99.1	99.2	-1.0
Colombo	100.4	100.5	100.3	98.4	98.4	98.3	-2.0
Gampaha	100.2	100.6	99.9	99.0	98.7	99.3	-1.2
Kalutara	100.8	100.8	100.9	99.1	99.4	98.8	-1.7
Kandy	99.6	99.5	99.8	98.4	98.6	98.3	-1.2
Matale	100.2	99.5	100.9	98.4	98.3	98.6	-1.8
Nuwara Eliya	99.4	99.3	99.6	98.0	97.9	98.1	-1.4
Galle	101.0	101.1	100.9	99.6	99.5	99.7	-1.4
Matara	100.0	100.3	99.8	99.9	99.1	100.7	-0.1
Hambantota	99.5	99.4	99.7	100.5	100.0	101.0	1.0
Jaffna	100.3	100.6	100.0	101.6	101.8	101.4	1.3
Mannar	100.0	98.8	101.2	98.7	98.4	99.1	-1.3
Vavuniya	99.0	98.9	99.1	100.5	100.1	100.8	1.5
Mullaitivu	100.2	102.0	98.4	101.1	101.3	100.9	0.9
Kilinochchi	99.8	101.0	98.8	100.8	101.8	99.8	1.0
Batticaloa	98.7	99.4	98.0	99.2	99.2	99.2	0.5
Ampara	100.3	100.5	100.1	99.0	98.6	99.3	-1.3
Trincomalee	101.6	102.3	101.0	100.4	100.8	100.1	-1.2
Kurunegala	100.1	100.0	100.1	99.5	99.4	99.6	-0.6
Puttalam	100.7	101.0	100.5	99.1	99.4	98.9	-1.6
Anuradhapura	99.7	99.8	99.6	98.4	98.6	98.2	-1.3
Polonnaruwa	100.3	100.2	100.5	98.9	99.1	98.7	-1.4
Badulla	101.1	100.8	101.4	97.6	97.2	97.9	-3.5
Moneragala	100.4	100.5	100.3	99.9	99.8	100.1	-0.5
Ratnapura	99.5	99.5	99.4	99.9	99.7	100.2	0.4
Kegalle	99.4	100.1	98.8	99.7	100.2	99.3	0.3

Table 12.5 presents the values of Whipple's Index by district and sex for the 2012 and 2024 Censuses of Population and Housing. For Sri Lanka, the value of Whipple's Index declined slightly from 100.2 in 2012 to 99.2 in 2024, representing a 1.0 percent decrease. This indicates that the accuracy of age reporting in the 2024 Census is comparable to, or slightly improved from, that of the 2012 Census.

At the district level, the values of Whipple's Index remain very close to 100 in most districts, indicating a high level of accuracy in age reporting. Notable decreases are observed in Badulla (-3.5), Colombo (-2.0), Matale (-1.8), Kalutara (-1.7) and Puttalam (-1.6) districts. Meanwhile, slight increases are observed in Jaffna (1.3), Vavuniya (1.5), Kilinochchi (1.0), Hambantota (1.0), and Mullaitivu (0.9). However, since these values remain close to 100, the age data in these districts can still be considered highly accurate. Overall, the results suggest that the age data collected in the Census of Population and Housing - 2024 are reliable and exhibit a high degree of accuracy, as reflected by the Whipple's Index values.